

VirtCruise Customer User Guide

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Guide overview

Purpose

This guide helps you discover holidays, request and review a quote, make a booking, follow payment activity, and manage your VirtCruise account.

Audience

This guide is for travellers. You do not need technical knowledge or previous experience with VirtCruise.

Scope

This guide covers customer features available in product version 0.7.0 and customer-facing work accepted during Sprint 3.7. It explains the currently released Manual Finance Mode. Features labelled **Future functionality** are not currently available and are included only to prevent confusion.

It does not explain internal consultant, Finance, administration, content, or support procedures. Those roles use separate manuals.

Before you begin

You need:

- a current email address that you can open;
- a supported web browser with cookies enabled;
- the right to accept the Terms and Conditions and Privacy Policy; and
- your quote, booking, invoice, or receipt reference when asking for help about a specific journey.

Your journey through VirtCruise

Register → Verify your email → Sign in → Browse packages
→ Request a quote → Accept a quote and create a booking
→ Follow Finance payment instructions → Booking confirmation

The steps do not all happen immediately. A quote is an offer for you to review. A booking is created when you accept an eligible quote. Finance must verify cleared funds before VirtCruise records payment or confirms a booking where payment is required.

How to use this guide

Exact website labels appear in **bold**. Status values appear as `STATUS`. Each chapter explains the purpose, steps, expected result, helpful tips, warnings, common mistakes, and related chapters. Screenshots are marked as controlled placeholders until approved images can be captured with fictional data.

1. Welcome

Purpose

Understand what you can do in VirtCruise and the normal path from account creation to a confirmed booking.

Follow the customer journey

1. Select **Register** and create an account.
2. Open the verification message sent to your email address and follow its instructions.
3. Select **Sign In** and enter your account details.
4. Browse **Packages** and **Featured Tours**.
5. Request a quote for the holiday or services that interest you.
6. Review the quote in **My Quotes**.
7. Select **Accept quote** when the quote is eligible and you are ready to proceed.
8. Review the new booking in **My Bookings**.
9. Follow the payment instructions supplied directly by Finance.
10. Check the Financial Portal for recorded payment activity and receipts.
11. Wait for VirtCruise to confirm the booking after all required checks are complete.

Expected result: You know which areas of the website support each stage of your travel planning.

If this does not work: Go to [Contacting VirtCruise](#) and provide the page name, time of the problem, and any safe on-screen reference.

Screenshot placeholder

Screenshot required — Figure 1: Customer journey overview

Views: Desktop (1440 × 900), Tablet (1024 × 1366), Mobile (390 × 844)

Content: Home page navigation and customer account entry points, using approved fictional data.

Alternative text: Main VirtCruise navigation showing Packages, Featured Tours, Sign In, and Register.

Capture required after WEB-006 acceptance. Store under `docs/customer/assets/doc-002/images/` using DOC-001 naming standards.

Tips

- Keep emails about your quote, booking, and payment until your trip is complete.
- Use the same email address throughout your journey so your records remain associated with the correct account.

Warnings

Warning: Never send your password or full banking details by email or through a general support request.

Common mistakes

- Treating a quote as a confirmed booking.
- Assuming a transfer is recorded as soon as it is sent.
- Using different email addresses for registration and later enquiries.

Related chapters

[Creating your account](#), [Requesting a quote](#), [Making a booking](#), and [Manual Finance Mode](#).

2. About VirtCruise Travels

Purpose

Learn how VirtCruise supports your travel-planning journey and what requires personal assistance.

VirtCruise Travels helps you explore holiday packages, provide your travel requirements, review quotes, manage bookings, and see customer-safe financial records. A travel consultant may help shape your itinerary. Finance provides and verifies payment instructions in the currently released Manual Finance Mode.

Explore the service

1. From the home page, review the main navigation.
2. Select **Packages** to explore available holiday ideas.
3. Select **About Us** to read the current company introduction.
4. Select **Contact** when you need personal help.
5. Select **Register** if you are ready to create an account, or **Sign In** if you already have one.

Expected result: You can distinguish self-service travel planning from activities that require a consultant or Finance.

If this does not work: Use the contact information shown in the website footer. See [Contacting VirtCruise](#).

Screenshot placeholder

Screenshot required — Figure 2: About VirtCruise Travels

Views: Desktop, Tablet, Mobile

Content: **About Us** section and nearby **Contact** navigation.

Alternative text: VirtCruise Travels About Us section with a route to Contact.

Capture required after WEB-006 acceptance.

Tips

- Package descriptions are a starting point; your quote contains the details prepared for your request.
- Read the quote carefully before accepting it.

Warnings

Important: Website package information and quote values remain subject to availability and final confirmation.

Common mistakes

- Assuming every displayed package is available for every date.
- Using package information instead of the accepted quote as the record of agreed travel arrangements.

Related chapters

Browsing holiday packages, [Featured tours](#), and [Contacting VirtCruise](#).

3. Creating your account

Purpose

Create a secure VirtCruise account and verify your email address.

Register

Prerequisites: An email address you can open, and time to read the Terms and Conditions and Privacy Policy.

1. Select **Register**.
2. Enter your **First name** and **Last name**.
3. Enter your **Email address**.
4. Enter a password of at least 12 characters in **Password**.
5. Enter the same password in **Confirm password**.
6. Review the password-strength message and strengthen the password if requested.
7. Read the Terms and Conditions and Privacy Policy.
8. Select both acceptance boxes only if you agree.
9. Select **Create account**.
10. When the confirmation appears, open your email and follow the verification instructions.

Expected result: The website displays **Check your email to verify your account**. After you use a valid verification link, your account is ready for sign-in.

If this does not work: Check the form for a field-specific message. Correct the highlighted information and submit once more. If no verification message arrives, check spam or junk mail and confirm that you entered the correct address before contacting Support.

Verify your email

1. Open the newest VirtCruise verification message.
2. Follow the verification link in that message.
3. Wait for the verification result.
4. Select the route back to sign-in when offered.

Expected result: VirtCruise confirms that your email has been verified, and you can sign in.

Screenshot placeholder

Screenshot required — Figure 3: Create your travel account

Views: Desktop, Tablet, Mobile

Content: Empty registration form and successful check-your-email state; no real personal details.

Alternative text: Registration form requesting name, email address, password confirmation, and policy acceptance.

Capture required after WEB-006 acceptance.

Tips

- Use a unique password that you do not use on another website.

- Enter your name as you want it associated with your customer account. Traveller document details are managed separately.
- Use the newest verification email if you requested more than one.

Warnings

Warning: Do not share a verification or password-reset link. It is intended only for the account holder.

Common mistakes

- Entering two different passwords.
- Using fewer than 12 characters.
- Forgetting to accept both required policies.
- Closing the process before verifying the email address.

Related chapters

[Signing in](#), [Privacy and security](#), and [Frequently asked questions](#).

4. Signing in

Purpose

Open your protected customer account and recover access safely when needed.

Sign in with email and password

1. Select **Sign In**.
2. Enter your **Email address**.
3. Enter your **Password**.
4. Select **Remember me** only on a private device if you want the website to remember your email address.
5. Select **Sign in**.

You may also see **Continue with Google** and **Continue with Facebook**. Use one of these only when it is the same sign-in method associated with your VirtCruise account.

Expected result: Your account opens, or you return to the protected page you originally requested.

If this does not work: Check your email address and password carefully. If needed, use **Forgot password?**. Do not repeatedly guess a password.

Reset a forgotten password

1. On the sign-in page, select **Forgot password?**.
2. Enter your **Email address**.
3. Select **Send reset instructions**.
4. Check your email. For privacy, the website uses the same general confirmation whether or not an eligible account is found.
5. Open the newest reset message and follow its link.
6. Enter a strong **New password** and confirm it.
7. Complete the reset, then return to **Sign In**.

Expected result: Your new password is accepted and can be used to sign in.

Sign out

1. Open your account menu or the portal navigation.
2. Select **Logout**.
3. Confirm that a protected account page is no longer visible.

Screenshot placeholder

Screenshot required — Figure 4: Sign in and recover access

Views: Desktop, Tablet, Mobile

Content: Sign-in form and **Forgot password?** link with empty fields.

Alternative text: VirtCruise sign-in form with email, password, Remember me, and password recovery controls.

Capture required after WEB-006 acceptance.

Tips

- A password manager can create and store a strong, unique password.
- Clear **Remember me** on a shared device.
- If you opened a protected page first, VirtCruise should return you there after sign-in.

Warnings

Warning: Sign out when using a shared or public device. Closing a tab alone may not be enough.

Common mistakes

- Using an unverified email account.
- Using an old reset email after requesting a newer one.
- Choosing a social sign-in method that is not associated with the account.

Related chapters

[Creating your account](#), [Customer Dashboard](#), and [Privacy and security](#).

5. Managing your profile

Purpose

Keep your contact details and travel preferences useful for future planning.

Update your profile

1. Sign in.
2. Open the account menu and select **Profile**.
3. Review the personal and contact details shown.
4. Correct the available fields.
5. Review the travel-preference fields.
6. Select the save control shown on the form.
7. Wait for the success message before leaving the page.

Expected result: The page confirms that the available profile information has been saved in this browser.

Important: Expanded profile details and saved traveller records currently use browser-only storage. They may not appear on another browser or device, and clearing website data may remove them.

Manage travel preferences

1. Open **Travel Preferences** from the customer portal.
2. Review interests, communication choices, preferred currency, and language.
3. Choose the available preferences that suit you.
4. Save the form and wait for confirmation.

Expected result: Your preferences are available in the same browser for later portal visits.

Screenshot placeholder

Screenshot required — Figure 5: Customer profile

Views: Desktop, Tablet, Mobile

Content: Empty or fictional profile and preferences fields; exclude passport and real contact data.

Alternative text: Profile page with customer details, travel preferences, and save action.

Capture required after WEB-006 acceptance.

Tips

- Update contact information before requesting important assistance.
- Add traveller details only for people whose information you are authorised to provide.
- Treat preferences as planning aids, not guaranteed booking requirements.

Warnings

Warning: Never save personal information on a public or untrusted device.

Common mistakes

- Leaving the page before the save confirmation.
- Expecting browser-only profile additions to appear on every device.
- Assuming a preference automatically changes an existing quote or booking.

Related chapters

Requesting a quote, [Customer Dashboard](#), and [Privacy and security](#).

6. Browsing holiday packages

Purpose

Explore published holiday ideas and identify a package that matches your interests.

Browse packages

1. From the home page, open **Packages**.
2. Select **Explore All Packages**, or choose a named package from the menu.
3. Review the destination, duration, summary, included services, displayed price information, and other package details.
4. Compare the package with your dates, traveller needs, and budget.
5. Use the package quote action when you want VirtCruise to prepare a personalised quote.

Available package pages in the current website include Victoria Falls Escape, Zimbabwe Safari, European City Break, Tropical Paradise, Dubai City Break, and Zanzibar Beach Holiday. Publication does not guarantee availability for your requested dates.

Expected result: You reach a package detail page and can continue to its quote request.

If this does not work: Return to **Home**, reopen **Packages**, and choose the package again. If the page remains unavailable, record the package name and contact Support.

Screenshot placeholder

Screenshot required — Figure 6: Browse holiday packages

Views: Desktop, Tablet, Mobile

Content: **Packages** menu and one approved package card.

Alternative text: Packages menu with Explore All Packages and published holiday options.

Capture required after WEB-006 acceptance.

Tips

- Write down your preferred dates and number of travellers before requesting a quote.
- Review what is included and excluded rather than comparing headline price alone.

Warnings

Important: A package page is not a reservation. Availability and final arrangements are confirmed through the quote and booking process.

Common mistakes

- Assuming a displayed starting price is the final price for every traveller.
- Skipping important details about dates or included services.
- Treating the package title as a booking reference.

Related chapters

[Featured tours](#), [Requesting a quote](#), and [Glossary](#).

7. Featured tours

Purpose

Use the curated Featured Tours area to discover travel ideas quickly.

Explore a featured tour

1. Go to the VirtCruise home page.
2. Move to **Featured Tours**, or choose **Featured Tours** from the **Packages** menu.
3. Review each displayed tour card.
4. Select the tour that interests you.
5. Read its full package page before requesting a quote.

Expected result: The selected tour opens with more information and a route to request a quote.

If this does not work: Use **Packages > Explore All Packages** to find the same or another suitable holiday.

Screenshot placeholder

Screenshot required — Figure 7: Featured Tours

Views: Desktop, Tablet, Mobile

Content: Current Featured Tours section with approved fictional or public package content.

Alternative text: Featured Tours cards that open detailed holiday package pages.

Capture required after WEB-006 acceptance.

Tips

- Featured means highlighted by VirtCruise; it does not mean the tour is suitable for every traveller.
- Open the full details before deciding whether to request a quote.

Warnings

Important: A featured tour can change, and its availability still requires confirmation.

Common mistakes

- Assuming “featured” means discounted or immediately available.
- Requesting a quote before checking the destination and duration.

Related chapters

Browsing holiday packages, Requesting a quote, and About VirtCruise Travels.

8. Requesting a quote

Purpose

Send VirtCruise the information needed to prepare a travel quote, then review the resulting quote in your account.

Submit a request

1. Browse to a package or service that interests you.
2. Select its quote or enquiry action.
3. Enter the requested trip information, such as destination, travel dates, and traveller details.
4. Add the requested flights, accommodation, transfers, visa services, activities, insurance, or special requests that apply.
5. Review every entry, especially names, dates, contact details, and the number of travellers.
6. Submit the request once.
7. Keep the confirmation or reference displayed by the website.

The available form can vary according to the package or services selected. Complete only information that is accurate and relevant.

Expected result: VirtCruise confirms receipt of the request. When a customer-visible quote is prepared, it appears under **My Quotes**.

If this does not work: Correct any field messages. If the result is uncertain, check **My Quotes** before submitting again. Contact Support if you cannot determine whether the request arrived.

Review a quote

1. Sign in and select **My Quotes**.
2. Use **Search quotes**, **Status**, or **Sort by** to find the quote.
3. Select **View details**.
4. Review the itinerary, travellers, services, special requests, notes, status, and estimated quote value.
5. Use **Print quote** if you need a browser printout.
6. Do not proceed until the details are correct and you understand the conditions.

Expected result: You can review the complete customer-visible quote. The value is labelled as subject to availability and final confirmation.

Future functionality: Downloadable itineraries, secure quote conversations, and customer quote-update requests are not currently available. Use [Contacting VirtCruise](#) for assistance.

Screenshot placeholder

Screenshot required — Figure 8: Quote request and My Quotes

Views: Desktop, Tablet, Mobile

Content: Quote request review step and customer-owned quote details with fictional data.

Alternative text: Quote details showing status, itinerary, travellers, services, estimated value, and Accept quote.

Capture required after WEB-006 acceptance.

Tips

- Give complete, accurate information to reduce follow-up questions.
- Mention accessibility, dietary, mobility, or other important requirements in the appropriate request field.
- Search by quote number, destination, or package name in **My Quotes**.

Warnings

Warning: Check traveller names and travel dates carefully. Corrections after arrangements begin may cause delays, availability changes, or additional cost.

Common mistakes

- Submitting the same request several times after a slow response.
- Assuming a submitted request is already a quote.
- Assuming a quote is already a booking.
- Overlooking customer-visible notes or special requests.

Related chapters

[Browsing holiday packages](#), [Making a booking](#), and [Notifications](#).

9. Making a booking

Purpose

Create a booking from an eligible quote and understand what happens next.

Accept a quote and create a booking

Prerequisites: You are signed in, the quote belongs to your account, and the quote displays **Accept quote**.

1. Select **My Quotes**.
2. Open the quote with **View details**.
3. Review the quote number, destination, dates, travellers, services, notes, value, and status.
4. Confirm that you want to proceed under the applicable terms.
5. Select **Accept quote** once.
6. Wait while VirtCruise creates the booking. Do not refresh or select the control again.
7. Review the booking details page that opens.
8. Keep the displayed booking reference.

Expected result: One booking is created and opens in **Booking details**. The booking also appears in **My Bookings**.

If this does not work: Check whether the booking already appears in **My Bookings**. If it does not, return to the quote and review its current status. Contact Support with the quote number if the result remains unclear.

Review or accept a booking

Some bookings may show **Accept booking** when their status is `PENDING_CUSTOMER_ACCEPTANCE`.

1. Open **My Bookings**.
2. Select **View details** for the correct booking.
3. Review the booking and payment summary.
4. If **Accept booking** is displayed and you agree, select it once.
5. Wait for the updated booking details.

Cancel a booking online

1. Open the booking details.
2. Enter a clear **Cancellation reason**.
3. Select **Cancel booking**.
4. Read the confirmation message carefully.
5. Confirm only if you intend to record the cancellation request.

Expected result: VirtCruise records the cancellation request and updates the booking when successful.

Warning: The website warns that an online cancellation request cannot be undone online. Cancellation conditions and financial consequences may apply. Contact VirtCruise before acting if you are unsure.

Screenshot placeholder

Screenshot required — Figure 9: Create and review a booking

Views: Desktop, Tablet, Mobile

Content: Eligible quote with **Accept quote**, followed by fictional booking details.

Alternative text: Quote acceptance control and resulting booking page with booking reference and payment summary.

Capture required after WEB-006 acceptance.

Tips

- Print the quote or booking view if you need an offline reference.
- Quote acceptance starts the booking record; confirmation may still depend on payment and operational checks.

Warnings

Warning: Before accepting or cancelling, check the booking reference and read the current terms. These actions can have financial or travel consequences.

Common mistakes

- Selecting **Accept quote** more than once while the page is working.
- Confusing quote acceptance with final booking confirmation.
- Cancelling the wrong booking because the reference was not checked.

Related chapters

Requesting a quote, Booking status, and Bank transfer payments.

10. Booking status

Purpose

Understand the status displayed for your booking and identify the next safe action.

Check a booking status

1. Sign in and select **My Bookings**.
2. Search by destination or booking reference if needed.
3. Choose a value under **Status** to narrow the list.
4. Select **View details** for the correct booking.
5. Review the status, booking timeline, travellers, services, and payment summary.
6. Check **Outstanding balance** and the payment status without assuming that either value changes immediately after a transfer.

Expected result: The current customer-visible status and booking information appear for the selected booking.

Status guide

Status	What it means for you	What to do
PENDING_CUSTOMER_ACCEPTANCE	Your decision is required on the booking page.	Review all details and select Accept booking only if you agree.
ACCEPTED	The booking has been accepted and arrangements can progress.	Follow any consultant or Finance instructions.
DEPOSIT_PENDING	A required deposit has not yet been verified as received.	Follow Finance instructions and keep your booking reference.
DEPOSIT_RECEIVED	The required deposit is recorded as received.	Review the booking and wait for the next update.
CONFIRMED	VirtCruise has confirmed the booking.	Review My Trips and keep the confirmation.
DOCUMENTS_PENDING	Travel documents are still being prepared or checked.	Follow any direct request from VirtCruise.
READY_TO_TRAVEL	Current arrangements are ready for the travel stage.	Review your itinerary and direct communications.
IN_PROGRESS	The trip is under way.	Keep your itinerary and contact details available.
COMPLETED	The recorded trip is complete.	Retain receipts and travel records as needed.
CANCELLED	The booking is cancelled.	Contact VirtCruise if you need clarification about consequences.

Status	What it means for you	What to do
REFUNDED	The booking record shows a completed refund outcome.	Compare the Financial Portal and contact Finance about discrepancies.

Status labels can reflect the details of your journey. When a status conflicts with a direct communication, contact VirtCruise before taking financial or travel action.

Screenshot placeholder

Screenshot required — Figure 10: Booking status

Views: Desktop, Tablet, Mobile

Content: My Bookings filters and a fictional booking status timeline.

Alternative text: Booking list and details showing status, reference, dates, deposit, and outstanding balance.

Capture required after WEB-006 acceptance.

Tips

- Search with the booking reference from VirtCruise communications.
- Refresh the page once if you have just received an update.
- Use **Print booking** when you need a paper or PDF printout from your browser.

Warnings

Warning: Do not travel, transfer money, or make non-refundable arrangements based only on an expected status. Use the current booking and approved instructions.

Common mistakes

- Reading the quote status instead of the booking status.
- Assuming `DEPOSIT_PENDING` means Finance has not received your message; it means payment has not yet been verified as recorded.
- Treating an outstanding amount as a self-service payment request.

Related chapters

[Making a booking](#), [Financial Portal](#), and [Manual Finance Mode](#).

11. Customer Dashboard

Purpose

Use one starting page to review recent travel activity and open common customer tasks.

Use the Dashboard

1. Sign in.
2. Select **Dashboard** from the account menu or portal navigation.
3. Review the summaries for upcoming travel, quotes, completed trips, saved travellers, notifications, and account security.
4. Review recent activity.
5. Select a quick action for the task you want to continue.
6. Use the portal navigation to open **My Quotes**, **My Bookings**, **Finances**, **My Trips**, **Travellers**, **Profile**, or **Notifications**.

Expected result: The chosen customer area opens. If there is no information yet, a clear empty-state message explains what can appear there.

If this does not work: Refresh once. If an area still cannot load, open it directly from the navigation. Record the page name and any Support details reference before contacting Support.

Screenshot placeholder

Screenshot required — Figure 11: Customer Dashboard

Views: Desktop, Tablet, Mobile

Content: Dashboard summaries, recent activity, security summary, and quick actions with fictional data.

Alternative text: Customer Dashboard summarising trips, quotes, travellers, notifications, security, and recent activity.

Capture required after WEB-006 acceptance.

Tips

- Use the Dashboard for orientation, then use the detailed page for a complete record.
- Empty summaries are normal for a new account.

Warnings

Important: A Dashboard summary is not a replacement for the detailed quote, booking, invoice, or receipt.

Common mistakes

- Assuming a zero or empty summary is an error without opening the detailed page.
- Looking for payment initiation on the Dashboard; current financial views are read-only.

Related chapters

[Booking status](#), [Financial Portal](#), and [Notifications](#).

12. Financial Portal

Purpose

Review invoices, deposits, payments, receipts, and refunds recorded for your travel.

Open your financial overview

1. Sign in.
2. Select **Finances**.
3. Review **Financial Overview**.
4. Check the outstanding balance, open invoices, next deposit due, and recent payment or receipt activity shown for the selected currency account.
5. Select **Invoices**, **Payments**, **Receipts**, or **Refunds** for the relevant history.

Expected result: You see only customer-safe financial records associated with your account.

Review invoices and deposits

1. From **Financial Overview**, select **Invoices**.
2. Use **Search invoices** or the status filter to find a record on the current page.
3. Review invoice total, amount paid, outstanding balance, currency, status, and booking reference.
4. Select **View invoice** for line items and totals.
5. Use **Print invoice view** if you need a browser printout.
6. Review the separate deposit schedule for requested, received, and remaining amounts.

Expected result: The selected invoice appears as a read-only record. Amounts always include a currency and currencies are not combined.

Review payments or refunds

1. Select **Payments** or **Refunds**.
2. Search by the available reference on the current page.
3. Filter by status when useful.
4. Review the amount, currency, booking reference where available, and current status.

Expected result: Recorded financial history appears. A missing record is not displayed as a zero balance.

Important: Financial Portal pages do not provide an online payment control. They show confirmed financial activity and amounts recorded by VirtCruise.

Screenshot placeholder

Screenshot required — Figure 12: Financial Portal

Views: Desktop, Tablet, Mobile

Content: Financial Overview and one fictional invoice in a single currency.

Alternative text: Financial Overview with balance, open invoices, next deposit, payments, receipts, and finance navigation.

Capture required after WEB-006 acceptance.

Tips

- Compare records using the booking, invoice, payment, or receipt reference.
- Check the currency beside every amount.
- Search and filtering apply to the currently loaded page of results.

Warnings

Warning: Do not use an outstanding balance as permission to pay to an account found elsewhere. Follow payment instructions provided directly by Finance.

Common mistakes

- Looking for a **Pay** control that is not currently available.
- Adding balances from different currencies.
- Expecting search to include every server page at once.
- Assuming a transfer is recorded before Finance verification.

Related chapters

Bank transfer payments, Manual Finance Mode, and Receipts.

13. Bank transfer payments

Purpose

Pay safely by bank transfer using the currently released Finance-led process.

Pay by bank transfer

Prerequisites: A booking or invoice that requires payment, access to your own banking service, and payment instructions supplied directly by authorised VirtCruise Finance staff.

1. Sign in and review the correct booking and invoice reference.
2. Select **Pay by Bank Transfer**.
3. Read the Manual Finance message and note the customer-safe invoice reference and currency shown.
4. Contact Finance using the contact route displayed on the page.
5. Ask Finance for the correct payment instructions for that invoice and currency.
6. Independently check that the message and payment details came through the approved Finance route.
7. Make the transfer through your bank, using the exact reference and amount instructed by Finance.
8. Keep your bank confirmation privately.
9. Wait while Finance checks that cleared funds have arrived and match your booking.
10. Review **Payments**, **Receipts**, and **My Bookings** for recorded updates.

Expected result: Finance verifies cleared funds, records the eligible payment, and progresses the booking. The booking remains pending until verification is complete.

If this does not work: Do not send a second transfer. Contact Finance with the booking or invoice reference, currency, amount, transfer date and time, and your bank's safe transaction reference. Do not send a password, security code, or full online-banking statement.

Why no bank account is displayed

VirtCruise currently operates Manual Finance Mode. The website deliberately does not display a destination bank name, account number, branch code, or international transfer code. Finance supplies the instructions directly so the correct account and currency can be checked for your booking.

Warning: Never transfer money to bank details taken from a search result, an old message, a social-media message, or a third party. Confirm any unexpected change using an approved VirtCruise contact route before paying.

Future functionality

Self-service bank instructions, creation of a bank transfer review case, and proof upload are not available in Manual Finance Mode. Do not look for or rely on those controls. If a later approved release enables them, this guide must be reviewed before those steps are used.

Screenshot placeholder

Screenshot required — Figure 13: Pay by Bank Transfer in Manual Finance Mode

Views: Desktop, Tablet, Mobile

Content: Contact-Finance panel, fictional invoice reference, currency, and copy-reference control; no bank account details.

Alternative text: Bank Transfer page directing the customer to contact Finance for instructions and showing the invoice reference and currency.

Capture required after WEB-006 acceptance.

Tips

- Copy the invoice reference from the page to avoid typing mistakes.
- Keep a private record of the transfer until the receipt appears.
- Allow time for the bank transfer to clear and for Finance to match it.

Warnings

Warning: Stop and contact Finance through an approved route if payment details are unexpected, have changed without explanation, or do not match the required currency.

Common mistakes

- Paying to details used for an earlier booking without reconfirming them.
- Omitting or changing the required payment reference.
- Sending another transfer because the portal has not updated immediately.
- Treating a bank confirmation as a VirtCruise receipt.

Related chapters

[Manual Finance Mode](#), [Financial Portal](#), [Receipts](#), and [Contacting VirtCruise](#).

14. Manual Finance Mode

Purpose

Understand the released payment experience and why a Finance hand-off is required.

What you see

When Manual Finance Mode is active, **Pay by Bank Transfer** remains available. The page displays:

- a message to contact Finance for payment instructions;
- approved Finance contact information supplied by VirtCruise;
- the invoice reference and currency associated with your record; and
- a control to copy the reference.

The page does not display bank account details. It does not offer automated proof submission, a review-case form, or self-service transfer tracking.

Complete the Finance hand-off

1. Open **Pay by Bank Transfer**.
2. Confirm the invoice reference and currency.
3. Select **Copy reference** if available.
4. Contact Finance using the information on that page.
5. Provide the reference and currency, then follow the verified instructions Finance sends you.
6. After transferring, wait for Finance to verify cleared funds independently.
7. Check **Financial Overview** for a recorded payment and receipt.
8. Check **My Bookings** for the resulting booking status.

Expected result: Your payment and booking change only after Finance has verified and recorded the funds.

Important: Sending money, sending a message, or providing a bank confirmation does not by itself mean that VirtCruise has recorded payment.

Why the booking remains pending

A bank transfer can take time to reach the correct account and must be matched to the right invoice. Finance checks the currency, amount, reference, and cleared funds. Until that check succeeds, no payment is recorded and the booking remains at its current pending stage.

Screenshot placeholder

Screenshot required — Figure 14: Manual Finance Mode

Views: Desktop, Tablet, Mobile

Content: Full Manual Finance customer message with controlled fictional reference and approved test contact values.

Alternative text: Manual Finance panel explaining that Finance supplies payment instructions and verifies cleared funds before booking confirmation.

Capture required after WEB-006 acceptance.

Tips

- Contact Finance from the current page each time you need instructions for a new invoice or currency.
- Give Finance the exact reference shown; do not shorten it.

Warnings

Warning: A request to ignore the approved Finance route or urgently pay changed bank details may be fraudulent. Stop and verify through a known VirtCruise contact.

Common mistakes

- Assuming the absence of bank details is a page fault.
- Searching elsewhere for VirtCruise bank details.
- Expecting upload or review-status controls that belong to future self-service functionality.
- Assuming booking confirmation happens before cleared funds are verified.

Related chapters

[Bank transfer payments](#), [Booking status](#), and [Privacy and security](#).

15. Receipts

Purpose

Find receipts issued after eligible payments have been recorded.

Review a receipt

1. Sign in and select **Finances**.
2. Select **Receipts**.
3. Use **Search receipts** to search by receipt, payment, or booking reference on the current page.
4. Choose a status filter if needed.
5. Review the receipt number, payment reference, booking reference, status, amount, and currency shown.
6. Compare the receipt with the relevant booking and payment history.

Expected result: Each issued receipt associated with your account appears in the receipt history. If there are none, the page displays **No receipts issued**.

If this does not work: First check **Payments** to see whether Finance has recorded the payment. If a recorded eligible payment has no expected receipt, contact Finance with the payment and booking references.

Future functionality: Receipt PDF download is planned but is not currently available. The receipt list is the released customer view.

Screenshot placeholder

Screenshot required — Figure 15: Receipts history

Views: Desktop, Tablet, Mobile

Content: Fictional issued receipt with references, amount, currency, and status.

Alternative text: Receipts page listing a receipt number, linked payment and booking references, status, amount, and currency.

Capture required after WEB-006 acceptance.

Tips

- Keep the receipt number when asking Finance about a recorded payment.
- Check both amount and currency.
- Use your browser's standard print feature if an accessible printout is needed and works for your device.

Warnings

Warning: A bank's transfer confirmation is not a VirtCruise receipt. A VirtCruise receipt appears only after an eligible payment is recorded.

Common mistakes

- Looking for a receipt before Finance verification is complete.
- Expecting a downloadable PDF.
- Confusing an invoice with a receipt.

Related chapters

Financial Portal, [Bank transfer payments](#), and [Glossary](#).

16. Notifications

Purpose

Review customer portal messages about quotes, bookings, and travel activity.

Review notifications

1. Sign in and select **Notifications**.
2. Review the message list.
3. Use **Search notifications** to find matching message text.
4. Use **Type** to narrow the current list.
5. Select **Mark read** after reviewing a message, or **Mark unread** if you want to return to it.
6. Use **Mark all as read** only after checking the outstanding messages.
7. Open the related quote, booking, or financial page to confirm important details.

Expected result: The read or unread state changes in this browser, and relevant customer messages remain visible in the list.

Important: Notification state is currently stored in your browser. It may not follow you to another device and may disappear if website data is cleared. Transactional email remains an important communication route.

Future functionality: Opt-in browser and mobile push notifications are planned for a future release and are not currently available.

Screenshot placeholder

Screenshot required — Figure 16: Notifications

Views: Desktop, Tablet, Mobile

Content: Fictional notification list, filters, and read control.

Alternative text: Notifications page with search, type filter, message cards, and read or unread controls.

Capture required after WEB-006 acceptance.

Tips

- Treat a notification as a prompt to open the authoritative quote, booking, or financial record.
- Keep your account email address current so you can receive transactional messages.

Warnings

Warning: Do not transfer money solely because a notification asks you to. Verify payment instructions through the approved Finance route.

Common mistakes

- Expecting a portal read state to synchronise across devices.

- Treating a notification as the full booking confirmation or receipt.
- Looking for push-notification settings that are not yet released.

Related chapters

[Customer Dashboard](#), [Booking status](#), and [Privacy and security](#).

17. Frequently asked questions

Purpose

Find concise answers to common account, package, quote, booking, payment, receipt, and Dashboard questions.

Registration and email verification

1. What do I need to register?

You need your first and last name, an email address you can open, a strong password, and acceptance of the Terms and Conditions and Privacy Policy.

2. How long must my password be?

Use at least 12 characters and follow the strength guidance shown on the form.

3. Why will the registration form not submit?

Check for missing names, an invalid email address, passwords that do not match, a weak password, or a policy acceptance box that is not selected.

4. Why do I need to verify my email?

Verification helps protect the account and confirms that you can receive messages at that address.

5. My verification email has not arrived. What should I do?

Check spam or junk mail, confirm the address you entered, allow normal delivery time, and use the newest message. Contact Support if it still does not arrive.

6. Can I register more than once with the same email address?

Use your existing account. If you cannot access it, reset the password or contact Support instead of creating duplicates.

Sign-in and password reset

1. Why can I not sign in?

Check that the email is verified and that the email address and password are correct. Use **Forgot password?** if necessary.

2. What does Remember me do?

It remembers your email address in that browser. Select it only on a private device.

3. Can I sign in with Google or Facebook?

Those options are shown on the sign-in page. Use the method associated with your account.

4. How do I reset my password?

Select **Forgot password?**, enter your email address, and follow the instructions in the newest reset email.

5. Why does password reset use a general confirmation message?

The message protects account privacy by not revealing whether a particular email address is registered.

6. What if my reset link does not work?

Request a new reset message and use the newest link. If it still fails, contact Support without forwarding the link.

7. How do I sign out?

Open the account or portal menu and select **Logout**.

Packages and featured tours

1. Where can I see all holiday packages?

Open **Packages** and select **Explore All Packages**.

2. What is a Featured Tour?

It is a holiday package highlighted by VirtCruise to help you discover travel ideas.

3. Does a displayed package guarantee availability?

No. Availability and final arrangements must be confirmed through the quote and booking process.

4. Is the displayed package price my final price?

Not necessarily. Review your personalised quote, which remains subject to availability and final confirmation.

5. Can I ask for a change to a package?

Include relevant needs in the quote request or contact VirtCruise. Secure quote conversations and online update requests are future functionality.

Quotes

1. What is the difference between a request and a quote?

A request gives VirtCruise your needs. A quote is the customer-visible offer prepared from those needs.

2. Where do I find my quotes?

Sign in and select **My Quotes**.

3. How can I find a particular quote?

Search by quote number, destination, or package name, and use the status and sort controls.

4. Is a quote a booking?

No. An eligible quote becomes a booking only after you select **Accept quote** and booking creation succeeds.

5. Can I download my itinerary from a quote?

Not currently. Downloadable itinerary generation is future functionality. You can use **Print quote** for the current browser view.

6. Why can I not see Accept quote?

The control appears only for an eligible quote in the accepted state. Review its status or contact VirtCruise.

Bookings and Dashboard

1. How do I make a booking?

Open an eligible quote, review it carefully, and select **Accept quote** once.

2. Where is my new booking?

It should open after quote acceptance and appear under **My Bookings**.

3. Does accepting a quote confirm my travel?

No. It creates the booking. Payment and operational checks may still be required before status becomes **CONFIRMED**.

4. How do I check booking status?

Open **My Bookings**, find the reference, and select **View details**.

5. Why is my booking still pending after I transferred money?

Finance must first verify cleared funds and match them to your invoice. Until then, payment is not recorded and the booking remains pending.

6. Can I cancel a booking online?

If the booking page offers **Cancel booking**, enter a reason and confirm carefully. The request cannot be undone online, and conditions may apply.

7. What does the Customer Dashboard show?

It summarises trips, quotes, saved travellers, notifications, security, recent activity, and common actions.

8. Why is a Dashboard section empty?

A new account or a stage with no matching records can have an empty state. Open the detailed page to check.

9. Can I print a booking?

Yes. Open its details and use **Print booking**.

Payments, Manual Finance, and receipts

1. Can I pay online in VirtCruise?

No online payment control is currently released. Finance supplies payment instructions directly in Manual Finance Mode.

2. Why are no bank account details displayed?

Manual Finance Mode deliberately directs you to Finance so the correct instructions can be checked for your invoice and currency.

3. How do I get bank transfer instructions?

Open **Pay by Bank Transfer** and contact Finance through the route displayed there. Provide the invoice reference and currency.

4. Should I upload proof of payment?

Not through the website in Manual Finance Mode. Automated proof submission is future functionality. Follow Finance's approved directions.

5. Does my bank confirmation mean VirtCruise has received payment?

No. Finance must independently verify cleared funds before recording the payment.

6. Where can I see my outstanding balance?

Open **Finances** or the relevant booking. Do not pay to unverified bank details based on the balance alone.

7. Where can I see payments recorded by VirtCruise?

Open **Finances > Payments**.

8. When will I receive a receipt?

An eligible receipt appears after Finance has verified and recorded the payment.

9. Can I download a receipt PDF?

Not currently. PDF receipt download is future functionality.

10. What is the difference between an invoice and a receipt?

An invoice shows an amount charged or due. A receipt records an eligible payment that VirtCruise has received and recorded.

11. Can I combine balances in different currencies?

No. Review each currency separately; the portal does not calculate exchange conversions or a combined total.

12. Who should I contact about a missing payment or receipt?

Contact Finance with safe references, the currency, amount, and transfer date. Never send a password or security code.

Profile and notifications

1. Will profile preferences follow me to another device?

Expanded profile and preference information currently uses browser-only storage and may not appear elsewhere.

2. Can I save passport documents?

Passport document upload is future functionality. Do not send passport images through an unapproved contact route.

3. Where do quote and booking messages appear?

Select **Notifications**. Important transactional messages may also arrive by email.

4. Are push notifications available?

No. Browser and mobile push notifications are planned for a future release.

5. What information should I give Support?

Give the page name, date and time, quote or booking reference if relevant, and any safe Support details reference. Never give your password or full financial details.

Expected result: You can answer the most common questions or identify the correct help route.

Screenshot placeholder

Screenshot required — Figure 17: Help and frequently asked questions

Views: Desktop, Tablet, Mobile

Content: Approved customer help entry point after WEB-006 acceptance.

Alternative text: Customer help route for account, booking, payment, and portal questions.

Capture required after WEB-006 acceptance.

Tips

- Use your browser's find feature to search this chapter by a word such as “receipt” or “password.”
- Follow the linked chapter when you need full instructions.

Warnings

Warning: Frequently asked answers do not override the terms, your current quote, booking conditions, or direct verified instructions from VirtCruise.

Common mistakes

- Reading only the short answer when a warning or procedure applies.
- Following advice for future functionality as though it were released.

Related chapters

All task chapters in this guide, especially [Privacy and security](#) and [Contacting VirtCruise](#).

18. Privacy and security

Purpose

Protect your account, personal information, travel records, and payments while using VirtCruise.

Protect your account

1. Use a unique password of at least 12 characters.
2. Keep verification and reset links private.
3. Select **Remember me** only on a private device.
4. Sign out after using a shared device.
5. Open **My Account** to manage your password and available security controls.
6. Contact Support promptly if you believe someone else accessed your account.

Protect personal and payment information

1. Check that you are using the expected VirtCruise website before entering account details.
2. Provide only information needed for your travel request.
3. Add information for another traveller only with proper authority.
4. Verify unexpected payment instructions through an approved VirtCruise contact route.
5. Never provide a password, one-time security code, or full online-banking details to Support or Finance.
6. Keep booking and financial references private except when sharing them through an approved help route.

Expected result: Your account and information remain under your control, and sensitive actions use verified routes.

Understand browser-only information

Saved travellers, expanded profile details, preferences, and portal notification state currently rely on the browser you use. They may not be available on another device and may be removed when browser data is cleared. Financial information is not saved in this browser-only store.

For the applicable customer policy, use the **Privacy Policy** link presented during registration or in the approved website contact/footer area. For contractual conditions, use the **Terms and Conditions** link in the same approved area.

Screenshot placeholder

Screenshot required — Figure 18: Account security and policy links

Views: Desktop, Tablet, Mobile

Content: **My Account** security area plus approved **Privacy Policy** and **Terms and Conditions** links; no account data.

Alternative text: Account security controls and links to the Privacy Policy and Terms and Conditions.

Capture required after WEB-006 acceptance.

Tips

- Use a password manager and enable device security.
- Confirm changed bank details through a separate, known VirtCruise contact route.
- Share the minimum information needed to resolve a request.

Warnings

Warning: VirtCruise staff should not need your password, password-reset link, banking password, or one-time security code.

Common mistakes

- Reusing a password from another service.
- Leaving an account signed in on a shared device.
- Sending identity or banking documents through an unapproved channel.
- Assuming browser-only saved details are backed up to the account.

Related chapters

[Creating your account](#), [Signing in](#), [Manual Finance Mode](#), and [Contacting VirtCruise](#).

19. Contacting VirtCruise

Purpose

Reach the correct VirtCruise team and provide enough safe information for assistance.

Choose the right help route

Need	Contact route	Safe information to provide
Account access or website problem	Support through the approved Contact area	Page name, date and time, email address, safe Support details reference
Package, quote, or itinerary question	Contact or your known consultant route	Package name, quote number, dates, requested change
Payment instructions, payment matching, or receipt	Finance contact shown on Pay by Bank Transfer	Invoice or booking reference, currency, amount, transfer date, safe bank reference
Privacy question	Approved Privacy Policy contact route	Nature of the request and enough information to identify your account safely
Terms or booking conditions	Approved Terms and Conditions or Contact route	Quote or booking reference and the condition you need explained

Ask for help

1. Open **Contact** from the website, or use the approved contact details shown in the relevant customer page.
2. State what you were trying to do.
3. Give the page name and the date and time of the problem.
4. Give the quote, booking, invoice, payment, or receipt reference when relevant.
5. Copy the safe request reference from **Support details** if the page provides one.
6. Describe the visible message in your own words or attach a privacy-checked image only when the approved route allows it.
7. Remove unrelated personal and financial information before sending.

Expected result: Your request reaches a team with enough safe information to investigate or advise you.

Warning: Do not include passwords, verification links, reset links, one-time codes, full card or bank details, passport images, or unrelated traveller information.

Screenshot placeholder

Screenshot required — Figure 19: Contact VirtCruise

Views: Desktop, Tablet, Mobile

Content: Approved website **Contact** and Finance contact routes.

Alternative text: VirtCruise Contact area showing approved routes for general and Finance assistance.

Capture required after WEB-006 acceptance.

Tips

- Use a clear subject such as “Payment matching — booking reference [reference].”
- Keep a copy of the request and response.
- For urgent travel disruption, use the approved assistance route provided with your travel documents.

Warnings

Warning: Use only contact details from the current VirtCruise website, your protected account, or verified travel documents. Do not trust an unsolicited replacement contact route.

Common mistakes

- Contacting Finance for a password problem, or Support for bank details.
- Omitting the relevant safe reference.
- Sending more personal information than the team needs.
- Trusting contact details copied from an unverified source.

Related chapters

About VirtCruise Travels, Bank transfer payments, and Privacy and security.

20. Glossary

Purpose

Understand the words used throughout the customer journey.

Term	Meaning
Booking	The record created when you accept an eligible quote and booking creation succeeds. It can still require payment and operational checks before confirmation.
Booking Confirmation	The outcome that tells you VirtCruise has confirmed the booking after required checks. Quote acceptance or sending a bank transfer is not by itself confirmation.
Booking reference	The customer-safe reference used to find and discuss a booking.
Customer Dashboard	The signed-in starting page that summarises your quotes, trips, travellers, notifications, security, and recent activity.
Deposit	A required part-payment associated with a booking. The Financial Portal separates the amount requested, received, and remaining.
Featured Tour	A holiday package highlighted by VirtCruise to help travellers discover ideas. Featured does not guarantee availability or a discount.
Finance	The authorised VirtCruise team that supplies payment instructions and verifies and records eligible payments.
Financial Portal	The read-only customer area for financial overview, invoices, deposits, payments, receipts, and refunds. It does not currently take online payments.
Invoice	A financial record showing charges, amounts paid, and the outstanding balance for a booking. It is not proof of payment.
Manual Finance	The currently released mode in which Finance gives bank transfer instructions directly and verifies cleared funds before recording payment. No bank account details or proof-upload controls are displayed on the website.
Notification	A customer portal message about quote, booking, or travel activity. Current read state is browser-only.
Outstanding balance	The amount the current record shows as not yet paid or allocated, stated in a particular currency.
Package	A published holiday idea with destination and service information. It is not a reservation.
Payment	Money that Finance has verified and recorded against the relevant customer financial record. Sending a transfer does not immediately create this record.
Quote	A customer-visible offer describing proposed travel arrangements and estimated value. It is subject to availability and final confirmation.
Receipt	A record issued after an eligible payment has been verified and recorded. A bank transfer confirmation is not a VirtCruise receipt.

Term	Meaning
Refund	Money recorded as being returned in relation to an eligible payment or booking, with a status visible in the Financial Portal.
Traveller	A customer or person included in travel planning.

Use a reference correctly

1. Identify whether the record is a quote, booking, invoice, payment, or receipt.
2. Copy the reference from that record.
3. State the record type when contacting VirtCruise.
4. Check the amount and currency on financial records.

Expected result: VirtCruise can identify the correct customer record without unnecessary personal information.

Screenshot placeholder

Screenshot required — Figure 20: Customer references

Views: Desktop, Tablet, Mobile

Content: Fictional quote, booking, invoice, and receipt references shown in their customer contexts.

Alternative text: Examples distinguishing quote, booking, invoice, and receipt references.

Capture required after WEB-006 acceptance.

Tips

- Always name the record type as well as the reference.
- Refer back to this glossary when a status or financial term is unclear.

Warnings

Important: Similar-looking references can belong to different records. Check the label before using one.

Common mistakes

- Calling an invoice a receipt.
- Calling a quote a booking confirmation.
- Omitting the currency when discussing a financial amount.

Related chapters

[Requesting a quote](#), [Making a booking](#), [Financial Portal](#), and [Receipts](#).

Related documents and customer links

- **Support:** [Support documentation index](#). The Customer Support Playbook (DOC-006) is a future internal manual and is not part of this customer guide.

- **Finance:** [Finance documentation index](#). The Finance Standard Operating Procedures (DOC-004) is a future role-specific manual; customers should use the contact route in [Manual Finance Mode](#).
- **Privacy:** Use the approved **Privacy Policy** link presented during registration or in the website contact/footer area. See [Privacy and security](#).
- **Terms:** Use the approved **Terms and Conditions** link presented during registration or in the website contact/footer area.
- **Contact:** See [Contacting VirtCruise](#) and the website's approved **Contact** area.
- **Other future manuals:** DOC-003 Back Office Operations Manual, DOC-005 Content Studio User Guide, DOC-007 Status & Lifecycle Reference, DOC-008 Quick Start Guides, DOC-009 Training Manual, and DOC-010 Technical & Developer Documentation are planned under the [Documentation Architecture](#). They are not currently available customer manuals.

Document review record

Gate	Responsible role	Decision	Date	Evidence or notes
Author self-review	Documentation Lead	Complete	2026-08-03	Grammar, terminology, structure, cross-references, and customer scope reviewed
Product accuracy review	Product Owner	Pending	—	Validate against target v0.8.0 acceptance baseline
Finance accuracy review	Finance Lead	Pending	—	Validate Manual Finance customer wording and contact presentation
Support usability review	Customer Support Lead	Pending	—	Validate recovery and escalation guidance
Privacy and security review	Assigned reviewer	Pending	—	Confirm customer distribution safety
Business approval	Business Owner	Pending	—	Required before customer distribution
Publication	Publisher	Pending	—	NDA and named-recipient checks required

Change history

Version	Date	Author	Change	Status
0.8.0-draft.1	2026-08-03	Documentation Lead	Initial customer guide covering the released customer journey and Manual Finance Mode	Draft